Sri Jagannatha-vallabha-nataka

"The Drama of the Beloved of Jagannatha"

A musical drama in five acts by Ramananda Raya

Translated from the Sanskrit and Prakrit

Translator's Preface

The *Śrī Jagannātha-vallabha-nāṭaka*, "The Drama of the Beloved of Jagannatha", is a Sanskrit musical drama (*saṅgīta-nāṭaka*) in five acts. Its author is Ramananda Raya, one of the closest associates of Sri Chaitanya Mahaprabhu. The drama tells of the love of Radha and Krishna in Vrindavana, from the first meeting of their glances to their union. It contains 21 songs (*gītas*) in the style of Jayadeva's *Gīta-govinda*. Each song has a named raga and a refrain (*dhruva*), and in its last line the poet names himself and dedicates the song to the king of Orissa, Gajapati Prataparudra.

Ramananda Raya according to the *Chaitanya-charitamrita*

Ramananda Raya, son of Bhavananda Raya, governed a province on the Godavari (Vidyanagara) under Prataparudra. Krishnadasa Kaviraja tells in the *Chaitanya-charitamrita* (CC Madhya 8) how Mahaprabhu, setting out on His pilgrimage to the South, sought him out on the bank of the Godavari on the advice of Sarvabhauma Bhattacharya. Mahaprabhu questioned him about the goal and the path of spiritual life, and Ramananda unfolded, step by step, the stages of bhakti. He began with the performance of one's own duty (CC Madhya 8.57) and rose to the pure love of the gopis and the supreme love of Srimati Radharani. The chapter closes with Krishnadasa's words that through Ramananda's mouth the Lord revealed rasa (Madhya 8.310–311). Later Ramananda left government service and settled in Puri, remaining at Mahaprabhu's side to the end of His pastimes (on the meeting with Bhavananda Raya and his sons, see CC Madhya 10).

CC Antya 5 relates how Ramananda, in a secluded garden, taught two young temple dancers (*devadāsīs*) to dance and sing "the songs of his own drama" (*nija-nāṭaka-gīta*, Antya 5.13–14). He taught them to express all the feelings of divine love with their faces, glances and movements, and then to perform before Jagannatha (Antya 5.24). Krishnadasa stresses that touching the young dancers did not disturb Ramananda's mind or body in the least, because he felt himself a maidservant of the gopis of Vraja (Antya 5.19–20). Such is the power of his devotion. This is the *Jagannātha-vallabha*: the drama was written for the temple of Jagannatha and was performed before Him.

Mahaprabhu heard these songs

During His last twelve years Mahaprabhu lived in Puri, in the Gambhira, absorbed in separation from Krishna (CC Madhya 2.3, 2.7). Krishnadasa testifies that in those days He "constantly recited the verses of Raya's drama" (*rāyera nāṭaka-śloka*, Madhya 2.17). Together with Svarupa Damodara and Ramananda Raya, He "sang and heard day and night", with the highest bliss, the songs of Chandidasa and Vidyapati, "the songs of Raya's drama", the *Karṇāmṛta* and the *Gīta-govinda* (Madhya 2.77). The last chapter of the CC says that Mahaprabhu recited the verses of Jayadeva, of the *Bhāgavata*, of "Raya's drama" and of the *Karṇāmṛta* according to His mood and relished them in ecstasy (Antya 20.67). Gaudiya Vaishnavas therefore honour this drama as one of the books Mahaprabhu Himself relished.

Srila Bhaktisiddhanta Sarasvati, whom we follow in interpretation, stresses that the pastimes of Radha and Krishna described here in the language of classical poetics are transcendental (*aprākṛta*) līlā. Its participants are Bhagavan Himself and His own pleasure-potency. The love of the gopis is prema, not

worldly passion, even though poets call it *kāma* (CC Adi 4.163–171). *Parakīyā*, love for Krishna as for "another's" beloved, exists only in Vraja (CC Adi 4.47) and is arranged by Yogamaya for the fullness of rasa. Such descriptions are meant for those whose hearts are purified, and they must not be understood in a worldly way or imitated. In his closing verse Ramananda himself calls the drama a "secret" for those who serve the pastimes of Gopala with faith (5.63). These passages are marked in the notes.

The 1901 edition

The translation follows the edition *Śrī Jagannātha-vallabha-nāṭakam. Śrī Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa-rāsa-krīḍā-viṣayam. Śrīyuta kavivara Rāmānanda Rāya praṇītam*. It was edited by Nityasvarupa Brahmachari, a disciple of Svami Prakashananda Sarasvati and recipient of the grace of the siddha Sri Radharamana-charana Dasa. The text was corrected by Pandit Lakshmanacharya of Vrindavan, and Sri Balakrishna Gosvami rendered the Prakrit speeches into Sanskrit (*chāyā*). The book was printed at the Devakinandana Press, Vrindavan, in Samvat 1958 (1901). It has 108 printed pages and a list of errata. An IA scan (collection of Dr Urmila Sharma, Varanasi, CC0) is kept in the repository: sources/south-india/ramananda-jagannatha-vallabha/.

According to the editor's Sanskrit introduction (*bhūmikā*), the drama had earlier been printed in Bengali script and is here reissued in Devanagari. The edition contains:

- the text of the drama (Sanskrit and Prakrit);
- a Sanskrit *chāyā* of the Prakrit speeches;
- brief Sanskrit glosses by the editor on individual words and figures of speech (e.g. "here the figure is *apahnuti*");
- a Hindi translation by the editor.

There is no old Sanskrit commentary (*ṭīkā*) in the edition.

What has been translated. Only the text of Ramananda Raya's drama has been translated: verses, songs, prose speeches and stage directions. The editor's introduction, glosses and Hindi translation have not been translated or paraphrased. In difficult places they helped with the sense, and this is then stated in a note. The Prakrit speeches (spoken by the women, the jester and some attendants) are translated from the Prakrit with the help of the edition's Sanskrit *chāyā* and are marked *(Prakrit)*. Modern translations of the drama have not been used.

Numbering. Within each act the edition numbers all passages consecutively — verses, songs, prose speeches and stage directions. We keep the edition's numbers only for the verses and songs; prose speeches are given without numbers, with the speaker's name. The verse numbers therefore run with gaps. A few verses are printed without a number or within a prose speech (e.g. 1.19, 1.26, 3.25a); this is noted.

The text. The scan is damaged in places (torn page edges, worn print), and the edition has a fair number of misprints. Corrupt passages are restored from the sense, the metre and the editor's Hindi translation, and are noted. Obvious misprints are corrected, taking the edition's errata into account. A working transcription made from the page images is in src/; the corrected Sanskrit text of the verses and songs with a word-for-word translation is in skt/.

Two versions. The light version contains the translation only. The full version gives, for each verse and song, the Sanskrit (Prakrit) text in Devanagari, an IAST transliteration, a word-for-word translation and the translation; prose is given in translation only.

Characters

- **Krishna** (Madhava, Mukunda, Hari, the Enemy of Madhu, etc.).

- **Radha** (Radhika).
- **Madanika** — Radha's elder friend and confidante. She is addressed as "lady" (*devī*), and Krishna treats her with respect. She is probably the same as the Forest-goddess (*Vana-devatā*) of Vrindavana (cf. Vrindadevi of the Gaudiya Vaishnava tradition).
- **Shashimukhi, Ashoka-manjari, Madhavi, Madana-manjari** — Radha's friends.
- **Ratikandala** — the jester (*vidūṣaka*), a brahmin buffoon, Krishna's friend.
- **The stage-director** (*sūtradhāra*) and **the actress** (*naṭī*, his wife) — in the prologue.

The acts

1. **Purva-raga** — first attraction.
2. **Bhava-pariksha** — the testing of feeling.
3. **Bhava-prakasha** — the revealing of feeling.
4. **Radha-abhisara** — Radha's tryst.
5. **Radha-sangama** — union with Radha.

Contents

- Act One. Purva-raga (First Attraction)
- Act Two. Bhava-pariksha (The Testing of Feeling)
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- Act Four. Radha-abhisara (Radha's Tryst)
- Act Five. Radha-sangama (Union with Radha)

Act One. Purva-raga (First Attraction)

Benediction and prologue: at the command of Gajapati Prataparudra the stage-director produces the drama of Ramananda Raya; Krishna enters Vrindavana with His jester-friend; hearing the flute, Radha comes to the grove with her friends; the first meeting of glances.

> ***1.*** *May the dance of Murari ever bestow happiness on the three worlds — accompanied by the music of the vina adorned with notes, the muraja drum and the flute; abounding in charming laughter as the creeper of His body bends in three places; resplendent with the clapping of His friends and the jingling of ankle-bells.*[1]

Moreover:

> ***2.*** *"Is it a smile? No — it is the white-rayed moon. A tremulous eye? No — a lotus. An ear? No — the bowstring with which the Mind-born conquers the world." May this illusion, born in the corners of the eyes of the cowherd maidens bewildered with eager joy at the orb of Mukunda's face, serve you for a hundred blessings.*[2]

Moreover:

> ***3.*** *Raising to the full the ocean of desire of the doe-eyed, making the night-lily forests that are the hearts of the self-controlled blossom utterly, and rendering the flocks of cakravaka birds that are the demons entirely stricken with grief — may the moon that appears in the guise of the face of Madhu's Enemy spread your bliss.*[3]

Song 1 — in raga Natana.

> ***4.*** *Worship the Enemy of Madhu, whose locks are stirred by the gentle Malaya breeze, encircled by the peacock crest; in whom eagerness has been awakened by the beauties with sidelong tremulous glances, their hearts filled with the darts of Manmatha;*
> *whose mind delights in love-play — worship the Enemy of Madhu, who longs for the moon-lovely faces of the cowherd girls. (Refrain.)*
> *Him, with neck lightly swaying, lovely with a fresh smile, who day by day dwells in the heart of Gajapati Prataparudra —*
> *thus charmingly, full of rasa, does Ramananda Raya sing.*[4]

(At the end of the benediction.)

Stage-director. Enough of prolixity! My dear, this way, this way!

(Enter the actress.)

Actress *(Prakrit)*. Here I am, sir. To gladden with a gracious glance the heart of the maidservant fallen at your feet — that rests with my husband alone.[5]

Stage-director *(joyfully)*. May you long enjoy, lady, the pleasures of youth, dressed as befits a connoisseur.

Actress *(Prakrit)*. For what reason has my lord called me?

Stage-director. My dear, do you not know this news of favour?

Actress *(Prakrit)*. Now my heart is bursting with curiosity to hear it.

Stage-director. Listen, dear. Today, at the close of a spring day — when the breeze that caressed the serpents, the braids lying on the Malaya mountain, the breast of the lady of the southern quarter forsaken by the young sun, had made the separated women faint, and the consoling words of their friends, the very elixir of life for the separated, were flowing; when in the clear forest of the sky the

flower of cool rays, the moon, had blossomed amid the star-buds that open ever anew like undrilled pearls, poised at the tips of the creepers that are the corners of the restless eyes of separated women gazing at it in deep envy — [I was commanded] by him whose mind, like the Milk Ocean, is fit to be the abode of Lakshmi's Beloved, who covets its matchless lustre of beauty;[6] a male cuckoo skilled in tasting the juice of the mango-buds of rasa ripened from vibhava and the rest;[7] whose heart is adorned with the pearls of virtues that accompany the necklace on the neck of Shri. What more need be said?

> ***10.*** *Hearing even his name, Sekandhara hides in a cave; the ornament of the land of Kalavarga looks about with tears; the king of Gurjara has come to regard his own capital as an old forest; the lord of Gauda knows himself to be as one aboard a ship on a storm-tossed ocean.*[8]
>
> ***11.*** *Is it the play of self-multiplication of the Lord's mountain, a double of the nectar-rayed moon, the extract of the Snow Mountain, a twin of the Milk Ocean, the essence of an autumn cloud? — The mass of his fame, sharing sovereignty with the waters of the heavenly river, ceaselessly purifies the world.*
>
> ***12.*** *Rejoicing at the embrace of the rivers formed by the streams of water poured with his gifts,*[9] *the ocean praises him under the pretext of the roar of its rolling, towering waves; and by the sacrifices he constantly performs the minds of the gods are so stitched to him that, in the form of sacred images (pratimā), they never leave his courtyard.*

By him — the Rudra of the fire of world's end to the hosts of hostile kings — by the illustrious Prataparudra I have been commanded to stage some composition concerning the feet of Sri Hari. As it was said:

> ***14.*** *"O best of actors, stage some composition resplendent with the play of the feet of Madhu's Enemy, rich in those very qualities of His, a source of complete delight to the hearts of the sensitive — a new work, not composed in another's shadow."*

Actress. Then tell me.

Stage-director. How is that treasure-house of learning to be honoured? For even the lord of speech, wishing to speak of him, would be at a loss. *(Reflecting a moment.)* Ah, I remember!

Actress *(Prakrit)*. What is it, then?

Stage-director. The poet Sri Ramananda Raya — son of Sri Bhavananda Raya, an ocean of jewel-virtues such as serenity, whose counsels, steeped in the many maxims of policy laid down by the preceptor of the gods, made the king upright and virtuous;[10] a poet whose mind is adorned by the feet of Sri Hari — has composed and offered the musical drama of Ramananda called *Sri Jagannatha-vallabha*, dear to Gajapati Prataparudra and adorned with all these qualities. That is what I shall stage. And the poet humbly said this:

> ***18.*** *"Let there be not even a whiff of merit in this so-called composition — still, it is our glorification of the lotus feet of Madhu's Enemy. That will surely be the cause of a flood of bliss for the connoisseur's heart; therefore this effort is not fruitless."*

So let the musicians be told to take up their vinas.

Actress *(using Sanskrit)*. As my lord commands. *(Looking ahead.)* Look, look!

> ***19.*** *On the lake whose ripples the gentle Malaya breeze has smoothed, this bee, yellowed with fresh pollen and drunk with the honey of every lotus, sleeps at evening from fatigue in a lotus cup, its limbs motionless.*[11]

Stage-director *(joyfully)*. Excellent, excellent, my dear! You have cast my mind into the whirlpool of an ocean of curiosity — for you have reminded me of Narayana in yellow garments, languid with the

fatigue of play full of drinking the honey of the lips of hundreds of cowherd maidens, sleeping somewhere on the couch of a heart adorned with the pillow of a mature young wife's breast.[12]

Behind the scenes:

> ***21.*** *Hari, Lord of the God of gods, endowed with the thirty-two marks, has gone with the cowherd boys to the forest by the Yamuna.*

Song 2 — in raga Kedara.

> ***22.*** *Behold Him — His peacock crest wreathed by a creeper whose shoots the softest breeze sets swaying; His tilaka mocking the crescent moon reflected on an emerald surface;*
> *in a dress that captivates young women — behold Him, as if the moon had come down to earth in a special form. (Refrain.)*
> *His face shines lovely with the lustre of jewelled earrings swinging in play; His sweet eyes, playfully darting, awaken longing in the young cowherd wives.*
> *May this noble form of Madhu's Enemy, sung by the poet Ramananda Raya, again and again give birth to joy in the heart of Gajapati Rudra, lord of men.*

Stage-director *(with a start)*. My dear, my younger brother announces Sri Krishna's going to Vrindavana.[13] Let us also go and prepare our costumes.

(Exeunt both.)

End of the prologue (prastavana).

(Enter Krishna as described.)

Krishna. Friend Ratikandala, look, look how lovely Vrindavana is! For:

> ***26.*** *These creepers and trees touch one another with moving hands, rows of shoots of boundless lustre; their flower-eyes are lined with collyrium, the quivering bees that embrace them; their buds are swelling as if with longing, and the beauty of their crowns sways; and as if intoxicated with the honey of spring, on every side they hold with one another a conversation full of rasa — in the calls of the maddened cuckoos.*[14]

Jester *(Prakrit)*. Hey friend, to you this Vrindavana is charming; to me it is just a dining hall — here some sweet curd, there some spiced drink, there fragrant ghee, there rice pudding.[15]

Krishna. Friend —

Song 3 — in raga Vasanta.

> ***28.*** *Ah, look: at this unheard-of form of yours, with its antics fit for the heavens, Vrindavana has long been laughing beyond all bounds — as it were with lovely clusters of opening flowers.*[16]
> *Behold, friend, the very essence of the earth — this Vrindavana of Mine, as if filled with rasa again and again at your coming. (Refrain.)*
> *As if with hosts of trembling leaf-hands struck by the gentle breeze, this delightful place seems ever to be teaching you to dance to your heart's content.*
> *May this utterance, charming to the heart of Gajapati Rudra, well-arranged, composed by the poet Ramananda Raya, delight the connoisseurs day by day.*

Friend, how very sweet is the cooing of the cuckoos!

Jester *(Prakrit)*. Hey friend, the sound of your flute is sweeter than that, and our voice is sweeter still. So you play the flute, and I'll sing.

Krishna. As my friend pleases. *(Plays the flute.)*

Jester *(Prakrit)*. Hey, your flute has been heard; now let my voice be heard too! *(Pulling a face, he bellows harshly. Looking at the treetops.)* Hey, we've won! At your flute these sons of a slave-girl, the cuckoos, only fell silent, but at my singing they've flown off who knows where. So, friend, don't be proud!

Krishna. Friend, look, look: some pitiless person has broken the fresh ashoka shoots — it grieves the heart.

Jester *(Prakrit)*. Hey friend, I've heard that those slave-girl's daughters, the cowherd girls, come here to gather flowers. *(Mockingly.)* That's exactly why you won't leave this Vrindavana.

Behind the scenes:

> ***36.*** *Having drunk to the full with the cups of her ears the sound of the flute of Madhusudana sporting in Vrindavana, Radha — her deep shyness loosened by awakening love — eagerly entered the circle of her friends.*[17]

Song 4 — in raga Gaundakiri.

> ***37.*** *She turns her glance in every direction, like a lotus stirred by a gentle breeze —*
> *Radha enters the grove of play, love's pain rising in her at every step. (Refrain.)*
> *Placing her soft, slow feet, she seems to imitate an elephant's gait.*
> *May these words of the poet Ramananda Raya bring joy to Rudra, lord of elephants.*

Jester *(listening, Prakrit)*. Hey, I've understood, I've understood!

Krishna. What?

Jester *(Prakrit)*. You're asking *me*?[18]

(Enter Radhika, followed by her friends, Madanika and the Forest-goddess.)[19]

Jester *(looking ahead, Prakrit)*. Hey friend, look, look: some conjurer has set a troop of golden dolls in motion — they're coming this way! I'll grab one and run off; one is enough to set a poor little brahmin like me up for life. *(Creeps forward slowly to seize one.)*

Krishna. Fie, fool! That is not a troop of golden dolls but a band of cowherd girls.

Jester *(looking closely, laughing, Prakrit)*. Well guessed! So your coming to Vrindavana has borne fruit.

Krishna. Fie, fool! What fruit has My coming to Vrindavana?

Jester *(Prakrit)*. I mean: protecting the fresh shoots of Vrindavana from these slave-girl's daughters.

Radha *(looking ahead, Prakrit)*. Noble Madanika, who is this — soft in lustre as a blue lotus petal, in garments like a heap of gold — who, His neck slightly bent, plays the flute so sweetly, so sweetly?

Madanika. Friend, don't you know? He of whom I told you:

> ***44.*** *This is that youth — the tree on whose branches the birds that are young women's hearts alight — Mukunda, shining as if the Five-arrowed himself had appeared: no sooner does He come into the path of beautiful women's eyes than the knot of their garment loosens of itself.*[20]

Krishna *(glancing briefly, aside)*. Ah, at what auspicious moment was this being born! For:

> ***46.*** *Though neither the lotus nor the moon is ever a likeness of this doe-eyed one's face, yet comparison never sets foot anywhere else but on them.*[21]

Jester *(Prakrit)*. I see: your heart is longing for those slave-girl's daughters, the cowherd girls. So come, let's get out of their sight and comfort ourselves with sweet curd and spiced drink. Look — it's midday.

Krishna. Friend, you have observed rightly. For:

> ***49.*** *"How is it, horses, that you are so tired from travelling merely the sky that here your speed has failed?" — as if to reproach his horses thus, the sun, having reached the middle of the sky, stretches out his ray-hands, as though measuring the heavens.*[22]

Jester *(peering a long while with screwed-up eyes, Prakrit)*. Friend, I too must describe the disc of the sun. Vishvakarma once mounted the sun on a lathe and spun it; I reckon the sun's disc is still spinning today from that momentum.[23]

Madanika. Friend, you are tired from your long walk; come, let us go.

(Exeunt omnes.)

End of the First Act, called "Purva-raga".

1. Verses 1–3 and Song 4 form the *nandi*, the benediction opening a drama. *Tribhaṅga*: Krishna stands with His body bent in three places (neck, waist and knee). Above the Hindi translation of this page the 1901 editor printed "Śrī Gaurāṅga-candro vijayate" ("May Sri Gauranga-chandra be victorious"); these words are not part of the Sanskrit text of the drama.

2. The figure *apahnuti* ("denial"): the thing named is denied and replaced by the object of comparison (smile → moon, eye → lotus, ear → Kama's bowstring). In their joyous bewilderment the gopis can hardly believe they are seeing Krishna's face and not the moon and lotuses.

3. Here and throughout, the "desire" (*kāma*) of the gopis is their pure love (prema), merely called *kāma*. Krishnadasa Kaviraja explains in CC Adi 4.163–171 and Madhya 8.215 that the gopis' love is called "lust" although it aims only at Krishna's pleasure, and differs from worldly lust as gold from iron. The moon of Krishna's face gladdens the gopis and the ascetics (night-lilies open at moonrise) but grieves the demons, as moonrise grieves the cakravaka birds, which by tradition are parted at night.

4. The closing line of the song (*bhaṇitā*) names the author and dedicates the song to the king. Krishna "dwelling in the heart" of Prataparudra points to the king's devotion. The phrase about "sidelong tremulous glances" is referred by the edition's footnote gloss to the beauties, not to Krishna, and is so translated.

5. Prakrit: by the convention of Sanskrit drama, women, servants and the jester speak Prakrit. These speeches are translated from the Prakrit with the help of the Sanskrit *chāyā* (rendering) printed in the 1901 edition; they are marked *(Prakrit)*.

6. The king's mind is compared to the Milk Ocean, the abode of Vishnu, Lakshmi's Beloved. This long clause has no main verb of its own; the verb "I was commanded" comes in the speech after verse 12. The right edge of page 6 of the edition is torn; three or four letters have been restored from the sense.

7. Vibhava, anubhava, etc. — the components of rasa in poetics; the king is called a connoisseur of rasa.

8. A eulogy of the king (*praśasti*). Sekandhara is probably Sultan Sikandar (Lodi) of Delhi, with a pun on *kandara*, "cave". Kalavarga is Gulbarga (the Bahmani sultanate), Gurjara is Gujarat, Gauda is Bengal. The beginning of the second line is corrupt in the edition (one syllable too many for the metre) and is rendered by the sense.

9. "Waters of his gifts": by rite a gift is accompanied by a libation of water.

10. Bhavananda Raya was Ramananda's father; in CC Madhya 10 Mahaprabhu receives him and his sons in Puri. The Sanskrit is partly corrupt here (printed "…*mantrā ṛvīkṛta*…") and is rendered by the sense. The compound also admits another reading, in which Bhavananda himself is called "lord of the earth" (*pṛthvīśvara*), that is, a ruler.

11. The verse is printed without a number and belongs to passage 19. The bee wearied with the honey of all the lotuses is a veiled image of Krishna wearied by His play with the gopis; so the stage-director understands it in his next speech.

12. Narayana is here a name of Krishna. The images of Krishna's love-play with the gopis in this drama describe the transcendental (*aprākṛta*) rasa, the eternal play of the Lord with His own pleasure-potency, which cannot be compared to worldly lust (cf. CC Madhya 8.137: in Vrindavana Krishna is the "transcendental ever-fresh Cupid").

13. By stage convention the stage-director calls the actor playing Krishna his "younger brother".

14. The creepers and trees are pictured as pairs of lovers: shoots are hands, flowers are eyes, bees are collyrium. *Utkalikā* means both "bud" and "longing".

15. The jester (*vidūṣaka*, a brahmin buffoon, the hero's friend) is a glutton and a simpleton, as the convention of Sanskrit drama requires. His name here is Ratikandala. *Śikhariṇī* is spiced sweet curd, *rasālā* a spiced drink.

16. The sense of *divocita-khelam* is uncertain ("with antics fit for heaven" or "fit for the day"); Krishna teases His jester friend, at whose appearance the flowers seem to laugh.

17. "Love" is *manoja* (literally "mind-born", a name of Kama). For Radha it is prema, the highest love for Krishna, not worldly passion (CC Adi 4.163–171).

18. That is, "you know it yourself".

19. Madanika is a friend of Radha. The Forest-goddess (*Vana-devatā*) is, in the Gaudiya Vaishnava tradition, a name for Vrindadevi.

20. The Five-arrowed is Kama (Cupid). In the Gaudiya Vaishnava understanding Krishna is the "transcendental Cupid" (CC Madhya 8.137), and what is described are the symptoms of loving agitation (*sāttvika-bhāva*) in His eternal beloveds. This is not worldly passion.

21. Radha's face is incomparable: the lotus and the moon are not its equals, and yet poets have nothing else to compare it with.

22. The sun, halted at the zenith, seems to scold the horses of its chariot. *Kara* means both "ray" and "hand". At midday the cowherd girls go home.

23. The jester's joke draws on the Puranic story that Vishvakarma trimmed the sun on a lathe to lessen its heat.

Act Two. Bhava-pariksha (The Testing of Feeling)

Madanika learns from Ashoka-manjari of Radha's longing; Shashimukhi hands Krishna Radha's love-letter; wishing to test the firmness of her love, Krishna feigns to reject her.

(Enter Madanika.)

Madanika *(looking ahead)*. Why, it is Ashoka-manjari!

Ashoka-manjari *(Prakrit)*. Lady, I bow to you. Where are you going so lost in thought, as if you had taken a heavy task upon yourself?

Madanika. Child, this is a weighty matter indeed.

Ashoka-manjari *(Prakrit)*. How so?

Madanika. Child, don't you know? We went with our dear friend Radha to gather flowers.

Ashoka-manjari *(Prakrit)*. And what happened there?

Madanika. There, at the foot of an ashoka tree, Mukunda became the guest of her eyes.[1]

Ashoka-manjari *(Prakrit)*. Surely the Flower-weaponed One has been up to some trick![2]

Madanika. Of course.

Ashoka-manjari *(Prakrit)*. Then what have you decided to do about it?

Madanika. Simple girl, must you ask me even that?

Ashoka-manjari *(Prakrit)*. Mukunda must be sought out?

Madanika. Of course.

Ashoka-manjari *(Prakrit)*. But how did you come to know the heart of one trembling with shyness?

Madanika. Child,

> ***15.*** *the armour of shyness stays firm in young girls' hearts only until the arrows of the Odd-arrowed One fall upon it.*[3]

Ashoka-manjari *(Prakrit)*. Even so — did she reveal it herself, or did you infer it?

Madanika. I inferred it myself.

Ashoka-manjari *(Prakrit)*. How?

Madanika.

> ***19.*** *She looks at the moon with no pleasure; at the calls of the maddened cuckoos she stops her ears on some pretext; in her friends' talk her answers make no sense — from this I understood something of Smara's play in her.*[4]

Song 5 — in raga Shri-gandhara.

> ***20.*** *Alas, alas! At the sandal breeze and the cuckoos' song her body shows the change the Bodiless One works; to hide it, how many, many childish games does she not suddenly begin! Seized by love's affliction, bearing burdens of ever new feelings — O Shiva, Shiva! — Radha languishes. (Refrain.)*
> *Again and again hiding the drops that fall from her motionless eyes, she suddenly goes aside to a friend in private and shows her the very essence of friendship.*
> *May this, spoken by the poet Ramananda Raya, charming the heart of Gajapati Rudra, live day by day in the assembly of connoisseurs devoted to the feet of Hari.*[5]

And where are you going?

Ashoka-manjari *(Prakrit)*. She told me too: "Friend, I long for a bed of fresh lotus petals — bring me such petals." So I am going for them.

Madanika *(aside)*. Ah, how cruelly the Flower-bowed One plays! I have heard:

> ***23.*** *Radha, in whom love swelled ever more at the southern breeze, the cuckoo's call and the humming of bees, reflected long, and then, fair-faced, in private said this in faltering words to her friend Shashimukhi:*

Song 6 — in raga Todi-varadi.

> ***24.*** *"A bed of opened lotus petals, hidden from the eyes of all my friends — to it my mind is drawn; prepare it quickly, fulfil this desire of mine, O moon-faced one!*
> *A bracelet of fresh lotus-stalk shoots, a dwelling sprinkled with sandal juice!" (Refrain.)*
> *May this, spoken by the poet Ramananda Raya, delight the heart of Rudra, lord of elephants.*[6]

Madanika. Go; may your paths be auspicious. And I shall follow Mukunda.

Ashoka-manjari *(Prakrit)*. Then I bow to you. *(Exit.)*

Madanika *(walking about, fixing her gaze on the sky)*. Ho, parrots, do you know where this Mukunda is to be seen? What do you say? "At the foot of the bhandira tree, with Shashimukhi"? Very well — I myself sent Shashimukhi there. What do you say? "And where are you going?" There, to hide and hear what happens. There I go. *(Exit.)*[7]

End of the interlude (vishkambhaka).[8]

(Enter Krishna with Shashimukhi.)

Krishna. This way, this way.

(Shashimukhi hands Him a love-letter.)

Krishna *(reads)*:

> ***29.*** *(Prakrit) "You pierce the heart deep — and Madana gets the heavy ill fame! You are seen in every direction, but Madana is seen nowhere."*[9]

Krishna *(aside)*. Ah, her love has gone beyond all bounds. Let Me test the firmness of her heart by feigning indifference.[10] *(Aloud, concealing His feeling.)* Friend,

> ***30.*** *who is this called Madana? Why has he come here? What wrong has she done that he pitilessly torments the fair-eyed one? Is he one of Kamsa's men? (Proudly.) Then tell Me where he is! Relying on My two arms alone I shall crush him and set this girl at ease. While I am here, should the women of Vraja know fear?*[11]

(Enter the jester, tossing the curtain aside.)

Jester *(Prakrit)*. Hey friend, he's no man of Kamsa — I'm the one called Madana! What will you do to me, a brahmin?[12]

Krishna. Fie, fool, enough of jokes!

Jester *(Prakrit)*. Lady, put a pair of laddus in our dear friend's hand — then our dear friend will go there and drive Madana away.

Madanika *(listening, aside)*. Ah, this is a messenger entrusted with the whole affair![13] For she, clever one, told Madhava in Vrindavana all sorts of things under the pretext of describing Radha's beauty. *(Looking closely, laughing.)*

33. *Drinking her words like streams of honey from an opening lotus, as if intoxicated, His crown swaying, Hari — though love was rising in Him, bent on hiding what was in His heart — slowly, slowly, with a lovely smile, said: "How is this?"*

Well, love that has passed all bounds brings sweetness.

Krishna *(reading the letter again)*. Friend, I have not quite understood this.

34. *Surrounded by the cowherd boys, on the bank of the Yamuna in Vrindavana, I enjoy some game or other; why then does this fawn-eyed girl see Me alone, plainly, in every direction?*

Song 7 — in raga Sama-gurjari.

35. *Ask this company of cowherd boys, friend, when I ever followed her! How does she see Me in every direction, how does she lose her senses?*
Friend, give up this play of words: if the cowherd boys learn of it, they will make great fun of Me. (Refrain.)
And if she, the very mountain-stronghold of her family, must abandon the custom of her family — why then should the girl bear this fainting love for Me?
May these words of Madhusudana, spoken by the poet Ramananda Raya for the joy of Gajapati Rudra, bring delight to all connoisseurs.[14]

Shashimukhi *(aside, Prakrit)*. Ah, my dear friend's love is misplaced! What is to be done here?

Jester *(Prakrit)*. Hey, what's the use of talking with this wicked cowherdess's daughter? Friend, look, look:

37. *(Prakrit) "The swan-maiden, driven by the sun's rays, seeks the shade of a cluster of lotuses — and you see how it, swaying in the wind, drives her away!"*[15]

Krishna *(aside)*. Ah, how cleverly the rogue turned his words! *(Aloud.)* Fie, fool, why do you talk beside the point?

Jester *(Prakrit)*. Hey friend, I spoke right to the point.

Madanika *(aside)*. Ah, Radhika, you are fortunate in every way![16]

Shashimukhi *(aloud, Prakrit)*. Noble one, to deceive one who is devoted to you is unworthy of such as you.

Krishna. Good woman, consider this too:

42. *her husband is dear to her; this girl is a guardian of her family's honour; why should the innocent one suddenly, without cause, overturn good conduct?*[17]

Jester *(Prakrit)*. Lady, our dear friend takes refuge in dharma, so off with you! *(Laying his hand on Krishna's heart.)* Lady, don't answer — she herself is scratching about inside my dear friend's heart. So I'll have to make everything plain. *(In His ear.)* Hey friend, you too have seen her a thousand times in dreams. Why then hide yourself now that she is before you?

Krishna. Fie, fool, how do you know My dream?

Jester *(Prakrit)*. What, do you leave me behind in dreams? No — there too I saw it all![18]

Krishna *(aside)*. Though this chattering little brahmin spoke from his love of joking, he has spoken the truth. So be it; still, the nature of young girls must be tested. *(Aloud.)* Good woman, turn this girl back from unseemly rashness. *(To the jester.)* Friend, come, let us also go and bring in the calves. Good woman, you too gently persuade her to desist.

Song 8 — in raga Mallara.

46. *The lotus does not love the moon, the night does not seek the sun. Such is the conduct of women of good family: to go to another man is grave sin.*
Shashimukhi, restrain the lotus-faced one, in whom love has blossomed for an unfitting object. (Refrain.)
If she does not regard the honour of her family — how should we not count it strange?[19]
May these words of Ramananda rise in the most compassionate heart of Rudra, lord of elephants.

(Exeunt omnes.)

End of the Second Act, called "Bhava-pariksha".

1. The print reads *tvayā locanātithikṛtaḥ* — "became the guest of your eyes"; by the sense and the edition's Hindi translation, "of her (Radha's) eyes".

2. The Flower-weaponed One (Kusumayudha) is Kama, the god of love; in the drama his names (Madana, Smara, Manmatha, Ananga etc.) stand for Radha's love, which Gaudiya Vaishnavas understand as prema, not worldly passion (CC Adi 4.163–171).

3. The Odd-arrowed One (Vishamabana) is Kama with his five (an odd number of) arrows. *Śilīmukha* means both "arrow" and "bee".

4. Signs of hidden love: the moon, the cuckoos and the spring breeze intensify the pain of separation (*viraha*), so Radha avoids them.

5. "O Shiva, Shiva!" is an exclamation of pity ("alas!"). The closing line calls the audience "devoted to the feet of Hari": Ramananda writes for Vaishnava connoisseurs.

6. A bed of lotus petals, bracelets of lotus stalks and sandal are cooling remedies for the "fever" of love-separation. The printed "*viṣa*" is to be read "*bisa*", lotus stalk. The word order of the song is unclear in places and is rendered by the sense.

7. The device *ākāśa-bhāṣita* ("speech to the air"): a character converses with an unseen interlocutor (here the parrots) and repeats the answers herself.

8. *Viṣkambhaka*: an interlude in which minor characters report what has happened or will happen.

9. The letter is in Prakrit, in the *āryā* metre. Radha reproaches Krishna: He wounds the heart, but the blame falls on Madana (Kama); she sees Krishna everywhere, not Kama — a sign of the highest love, in which the beloved is seen everywhere. The edition's Sanskrit *chāyā* has the verb in the third person (*vidhyati*); the translation follows the Prakrit (*vijjhasi*, second person).

10. The key to the whole act: Krishna only feigns indifference in order to test the firmness of Radha's love (*bhāva-parīkṣā*, "testing of feeling").

11. Krishna deliberately takes "Madana" literally, as a man's name, and offers to deal with him as with the demons Kamsa used to send.

12. The jester takes up the game: "Madana" is both Kama and, so he claims, his own name — and a brahmin may not be punished.

13. *Nisṛṣṭārtha-dūtī*: in poetics, a "messenger with full authority", who herself decides what to say and how to arrange the meeting.

14. "Mountain-stronghold of her family" — that is, one faithful to the custom of her family. Krishna continues His feigned test (see note 10).

15. Prakrit, *āryā* metre. An allegory: Radha (the swan), driven by the heat of love, seeks refuge with Krishna (the lotus cluster), but He, "swaying" (feigning hesitation), pushes her away. The end of the line is rendered approximately from the edition's *chāyā*.

16. Madanika sees that Krishna loves Radha too and is only hiding it.

17. Here and in Song 8 Krishna appeals to worldly morality. But this is only a test, as He Himself says aside twice (before verse 30 and after verse 44) — just as in the *Bhāgavata* (10.29) Krishna first advises the gopis to go back to their husbands. According to Gaudiya Vaishnava teaching the gopis are Krishna's eternal associates, His own pleasure-potency (*hlādinī*). Their "marriage" to others is arranged by Yogamaya for the fullness of rasa, and the *parakīyā* love (love as for "another's" beloved) exists only in Vraja (CC Adi 4.47). Srila Bhaktisiddhanta Sarasvati stresses that this transcendental *parakīyā* cannot be measured by worldly morality and must not be imitated in this world.

18. The jester, the hero's constant companion, jokes that he is with Krishna even in His dreams.

19. The line is unclear (printed *kimiti vayaṁ kalayāma na citram*). The edition's Hindi translation takes it differently: "…why should we abandon our own bounds?"

Act Three. Bhava-prakasha (The Revealing of Feeling)

Radha despairs at Krishna's feigned refusal; her friends console her; Madhavi brings from Krishna a picture with Radha's portrait and a verse, a sign of His love; Radha sends Madanika to Krishna.

(Enter Ashoka-manjari.)

Ashoka-manjari *(Prakrit)*. Ah, I have heard that my dear friend, with Madanika, the Forest-goddess and Shashimukhi, is sitting near the bower of madhavi creepers, plotting some secret. I'll take a look and go. *(Looking ahead and approaching.)* Ah, they are whispering something very softly. It would not be right for me to go in there. *(Exit.)*

(Enter Radha, being admonished by Shashimukhi and Madanika.)

Radha *(sighing long and hot, Prakrit)*. So Madhava has really rejected me!

Song 9 — in raga Sama-gurjari.

> ***3.*** *The conduct that women of good family keep, I, losing my reason, counted as a straw.*
> *O Shiva, Shiva, what an unworthy thing I have done! Say, Fate: who now will win Him over? (Refrain.)*
> *I am still a girl, yet I am full of feelings like a grown woman; who else, like me, has thrown off shame?*
> *For the joy of Gajapati Rudra this song of the poet Ramananda Raya has been sung.*[1]

Shashimukhi *(Prakrit)*. I have told you everything as it happened; so judge for yourself.

Radha *(using Sanskrit)*.

> ***5.*** *Hearing again and again the sound of His flute, the Parabrahman in harmony with the fair chants of the Sama Veda; seeing again and again the essence of the beauty of the finest youth of the three worlds, skilled in play; meditating again and again on Him, radiant as the rising sun and the moon — the beloved of Shri — I feel my mind burning me like a smouldering fire of chaff.*[2]

Shashimukhi *(using Sanskrit)*. Friend, give up this misplaced insistence.

> ***7.*** *Whatever I told Krishna for your sake, He warded it all off by making a show of being a mere child. Enough! Let that poison be — the thought of Krishna, steeped in the honey dripping from the flowers of your longing; turn your desire elsewhere, fair-faced one.*[3]

Song 10 — in raga Suhayi.

> ***8.*** *A woman serves her husband even if he is unworthy; does a doe choose a lion?*
> *Radhika, give up your love for Madhava! (Refrain.)*
> *And when the moon wanes, does the forest of night-lilies cease to love it?*[4]
> *May Ramananda Raya's song ever delight King Gajapati Rudra.*

Radha *(in tears)*. Lady Madanika, what is this?

> ***9.*** *Hari does not know the pain of love broken off; love does not know what is its place and what is not; Madana does not understand that we are weak; no one knows another's pain in full; our life is not in our power; and this youth lasts but two or three days. Alas, alas, what a course Fate takes!*[5]

Madanika. Why do you torment yourself so? For:

10. *If a bee, drawn from afar by the rich fragrance of a ketaki flower, has come to it — then even if, circling and circling, she finds little nectar in its pollen, once she has reached it she does not leave it.*[6]

Radha *(taking courage)*. "He has rejected me already" — having said this only half-way, in fear and trembling: Lady, this is not my fault. For

11. *when by the will of fate the Enemy of Madhu came into the path of my eyes, then that wretch Madana stole my heart.*
(Pausing a moment and sighing long and hot.)
If He comes again even for a moment into the path of my eyes, I shall set every moment of that time with jewels.[7]

Madanika *(aside)*. Her love has passed all bounds. Let me divert her mind with the most welcome news. *(Aloud.)* Child, look, look:

13. *The young mango tree that you, lovely one, raised by watering its roots from the lotus of your hand — its crown is now bristling with buds; I think that is why the bees are speaking sweet words to it.*[8]

Radha *(in fear and trembling)*. Friend Shashimukhi, remember me![9]

Madanika *(aside)*. Ah, what a train of misfortunes has come upon us! *(Aloud.)* Child, do not lose heart so: I have noticed that His heart is full of love.

Song 11 — in raga Deshaga.

15. *Look: how is it that His lotus face constantly bristles with gooseflesh at sweet tales? How does He, leaving thousands of games, smile so charmingly with a fresh smile?*
Innocent one, give up your excessive fears! (Refrain.)
How He speaks again and again, with respect and tenderness, to your friend about the heart of the matter, fair-faced one! Can your mind not reason about this?[10]
May these words of the poet Ramananda Raya long dwell in the heart of Gajapati Rudra, lord of men, which is the very essence of rasa and versed in the knowledge of play.

Radha. Lady,

16. *water is only guessed at in the cloud, while the flames of the forest fire have already seized the body. The body is so tender and she is still a child — O Shiva, Shiva, how will the doe survive?*[11]

Madanika. Child, to find this out I sent Madhavi with a picture bearing your likeness.

(Enter Madhavi with a picture in her hand.)

Madhavi. Lady, I bow to you.

Madanika. Welcome, child. Have you too learnt the secret?

Madhavi. Of course.

Madanika. Then tell it.

Madhavi *(shows the picture)*.

Radha *(bashfully asks for the picture)*.

Madhavi. First give me a reward for good news!

Madanika *(aside)*. Surely Mukunda, clearly understanding her heart, has fallen in love too.

(Unnumbered.) "For if the sprout of love should ever break through carelessness, it cannot be joined again."

(Aloud.) Child, hand over the picture.

Madhavi *(showing it a little, covers it with the edge of her garment).*

Shashimukhi *(seizing it by force, looks at it. Prakrit).* Ah, what are these letters? *(Reads.)*

***27.** "Do not fear, fair-faced one, that he has turned away from you: whom would a lotus opening for the first time not delight? And though the youth loses his composure at the very first breath of its fragrance — how could he remain indifferent even for a moment?"*[12]

Madhavi *(Prakrit).* Friend, may you flourish in your beloved's love!

Radha *(sighing long and hot, Prakrit).* Ah, friend, where would we find such good fortune? *(To Madanika.)* What does this mean?

Madanika. This: clearly understanding your heart, Mukunda too has fallen in love. "For if the sprout of love should ever break through carelessness, it cannot be joined again." So, child, do not be distressed: the tree of our desires has borne fruit.

Radha *(Prakrit).* Even now I do not believe it. You alone are my refuge here.

Madanika. Here I go then; give me leave.

Radha *(bowing, using Sanskrit).* Revered lady,

***33.** this grove is thick with swarms of humming bees; the jewel of the day has probably gone behind the peak of the western mountain; the breeze gently, gently stirs the bees on the jasmine; what more is there to say — the moon too is about to rise.*[13]

Song 12 — in raga Karnata.

***34.** The grove where the bees hum so sweetly is now so terrible; the gentle fragrant breeze does me harm.*
All this I have told you. And more: because of the heavy five arrows my life is wavering. (Refrain.)
The forest, where maddened cuckoos give pain, is the highest torment; even the body, made for the joy of union, has become a vessel of great fear.
May this radiant song, made by the poet Raya whose name is "Rama", soon fill King Rudra with happiness.[14]

Madanika. Child, look for me at the foot of the vakula tree. *(Exit.)*

(Exeunt the others too.)

End of the Third Act of the drama "Sri Jagannatha-vallabha", called "Bhava-prakasha".

1. Radha believes herself rejected and reproaches herself for having disregarded convention, not knowing that Krishna's refusal was only a test (Act 2). For Gaudiya Vaishnavas her readiness to sacrifice everything, even her good name, is a sign of the highest selfless love (CC Adi 4.167–169: for Krishna's sake the gopis gave up everything — worldly custom and Vedic duty alike).

2. *Sragdharā* metre. The sound of Krishna's flute is called the Parabrahman in harmony with the chants of the Sama Veda: the Absolute itself is in the sound of His flute. "Beloved of Shri" (*Śrīkānta*) is Krishna. The end of the fourth line is corrupt in the edition and is rendered by the sense and the edition's Hindi translation. A fire of chaff (*kukūla*) smoulders slowly and long — an image of the unquenchable pain of separation.

3. Shashimukhi, like Madanika, tests the firmness of Radha's love. The beginning of the verse is unclear in the edition and is rendered by the sense.

4. Shashimukhi says that a wife stays faithful to her husband (the doe does not choose the lion) — but at once refutes herself: the lilies love the moon even when it wanes, that is, true love does not depend on the beloved's merits. A proverb spoken in consolation may mean the very opposite.

5. *Śārdūla-vikrīḍita* metre. The last words of the third line are unclear in the edition and are rendered by the sense and the edition's Hindi translation.

6. The first line is corrupt in the edition; the sense is restored from the Hindi translation: a bee once drawn to a flower does not leave it. Madanika consoles Radha: Krishna, having once seen her, will not abandon her.

7. "Set with jewels" — that is, count every moment a treasure. The fourth line is one syllable short in the print and has been corrected by the metre.

8. An allegory: the young tree Radha has raised is Krishna's love, nurtured by her; the bees that cling to its buds are a sign that love is about to blossom. Madanika hints at good news.

9. Radha fears she will die of separation and asks her friend to remember her.

10. Madanika recounts how Krishna listened to her stories about Radha: His feelings betray His love. A line of the song is partly unclear in the edition.

11. *Āryā* metre. The cloud is Krishna, the water the hope of meeting, the fire the heat of separation; the doe is Radha herself. The last word is corrupt in the print and is read as *bhavitā*.

12. *Mandākrāntā* metre. This is Krishna's verse on the picture with Radha's portrait: the lotus opening for the first time is Radha, the youth who breathes its fragrance is Krishna Himself. His earlier refusal (Act 2) was only feigned. The beginning of the fourth line is unclear in the edition.

13. *Śikhariṇī* metre. Nightfall and moonrise intensify the pain of separation; Radha asks Madanika to hurry.

14. "The poet Raya whose name is 'Rama'" is a play on the name of Ramananda Raya.

Act Four. Radha-abhisara (Radha's Tryst)

Krishna, suffering in separation, repents of His pretence; Madanika tells Him of Radha's sufferings and at His request goes to bring her; Radha comes to the appointed grove; Krishna waits for her anxiously as the moon rises; the meeting.

(Enter Madanika.)

Madanika. Ah, I heard from Madana-manjari that Mukunda is sitting with the little brahmin at the foot of the vakula tree; I'll go there. *(Looking ahead.)* Ah, here is Mukunda, consulting dejectedly about something with the brahmin. Surely the Flower-arrowed One has been at play here. Let me hide behind the madhavi bush and listen. *(She hides.)*

(Enter Krishna, acting the state of one in love, talking with the jester.)

Madanika *(aside)*.

Song 13 — in raga Malava.

> ***2.*** *This face, sweet as the moon's orb — alas, it has long been faded, like a lotus struck by the moon's ray, wounded day and night by the arrows of the Bodiless One.*
> *The great pain of Madhava's body splits my heart in two, into a hundred pieces. (Refrain.)*
> *His broad chest, having cast off its necklace, has turned grey with separation — ah, is it an emerald rock struck by a moonbeam?*
> *May the lovely song spoken by the poet Ramananda Raya delight Gajapati Rudra, ocean of good deeds — cooler than moonlight.*[1]

Krishna.

> ***3.*** *If that lotus-eyed one revealed to Me her boundless love through her friend's lips, and I contrived this mockery — alas, alas, I have thrown away a great jewel, thinking it a shell! If only by fate she might come again within sight of My eyes, through My countless merits!*[2]

Jester *(Prakrit)*. Hey friend, didn't I tell you not to reject this loving girl? Why do you pine now? When the appetite is gone, what's the use of laddus and sweets? So here I'm the only remedy.

Krishna. How so?

Jester *(Prakrit)*. I'm a brahmin: I'll keep repeating a mantra over and over and draw her here![3]

Krishna. I know your brahminhood. Look rather — here is Madanika.

Madanika *(coming forward)*. Blessings on you, child.

Krishna *(looking ahead)*. What, Madanika? *(Respectfully.)* Lady, welcome.

Madanika. Noble one, to see the moon of your face is all the welfare I need.

Jester *(Prakrit)*. Our dear friend is tormented by the Flower-arrowed One; so bring that very cowherd girl!

Krishna *(embarrassed)*. Fie, fool, don't talk like that!

Jester *(Prakrit)*. We brahmins are simple folk — we speak plainly.

Madanika *(smiling)*. Child, you are truthful indeed.

Jester *(Prakrit)*. Of course! Look, look — here are lotus leaves! *(He shows dry, rustling leaves. Then, using Sanskrit:)*[4]

Song 14 — in raga Duhkhi-varadi.

15. *In the lotus grove not a flower, not a petal is left, for the sake of Vanamali; and in Vrindavana you see only lovely opening shoots.*
Simple girl, don't you see Krishna? He has placed all His hope in you, forgotten His play — like a chataka bird thirsting for the cloud. (Refrain.)
Looking at the moon, He keeps saying: "Bring Rahu quickly!" — tell me, how could He speak so if Madana were not dwelling in His heart, staging his games?[5]
May this fine song of Ramananda Raya, full of separation from Hari, who is secretly vanquished by the arrows of the Mind-born, increase the joy of Gajapati Rudra.

Madanika. Is that all?

Jester *(Prakrit)*. You've become our dear friend's friend, yet you don't understand even what's been said. Very well, I'll go myself and bring her — I too am an envoy with full powers! *(He starts to go.)*

Krishna *(catches him by his upper cloth)*.

Madanika. Child Krishna, why hide anything from me?

Krishna. Lady, I want to ask you something.

Madanika. Speak freely.

Krishna.

22. *Ever since you told Me that she scorns the lustre of the moon's face — let the moon torment Me! But the Malaya breeze, which I prized so much because it touches her body — how can it too toy with My life?*[6]

Madanika *(aside)*. Radhika's wish has been fulfilled together with ours. Let me tell Him of her pain of separation too. *(Aloud.)* Child, of that lovely one too only her beauty remains. For:

24. *This slender one, grinding sandal and cool moon on a golden stone slab, seeks something to anoint her body. Pausing a moment — alas, alas! — she rose from her bed of juicy lotus leaves before they could catch fire and start to rustle.*[7]

Song 15 — in raga Sama-todi.

25. *Emaciated, she falls in the mire endlessly made by the tears of her eyes, and her feet slip.*
Madhava, the pain of love is heavy! Hari, Hari, Radha is barely alive. (Refrain.)
How do You dwell in her heart — and yet torment it? O Shiva, Shiva, and still You do not quench her longing![8]
May Ramananda's flawless song delight King Gajapati Rudra.

Jester *(Prakrit)*. Lady, I reckon cowherd girls are reckless: they go looking for ointment of moon and sandal. But our dear friend, seeing the moon, hides his body somewhere and sits with his eyes shut, like an owl before the sun; and if he catches even a breath of sandal-wind, he darts this way and that like a snake at a potent spell.[9]

Krishna *(aside)*. Well said. *(Aloud.)* Fie, fool, don't chatter so!

Madanika. How many rules of duty were not preached to her to test her heart!

Krishna *(aside, anxiously)*. Can she have turned away from her longing for Me?

Madanika. So then:

30. *when she disregards the rebukes of her elders, when she takes no pleasure in her friends' jests full of rasa, when she sees sandal as poison and the moon as fire — then I came here to tell You of her state.*[10]

Krishna *(with a sigh of relief).*

> ***31.*** *Since you, a stranger to deceit, in causeless affection would draw Me out even from the ocean of Smara — then win her over and bring her to the bower-house by the keshara tree. Show your skill!*[11]

Madanika. Child, it shall be so.

Jester *(Prakrit)*. Simple lady, this is true indeed — I, a brahmin, stand surety for it.

Krishna. Enough of doubts — accomplish My cause.

Madanika. Here I go. Blessings on you, child. *(Exit.)*

(Enter Radhika, dressed for the tryst.)

Radha *(Prakrit)*. Friend Madhavi, you have deceived me!

Song 16 — in raga Ramakeli.

> ***37.*** *The path is hidden in darkness; mountains and caves — all have become level ground.*
> *Why, friend, does the lady delay? Does even Fate not wish me well? (Refrain.)*
> *Have I crossed this fearful, boundless, dense forest in vain?*
> *May this, made by Ramananda Raya, ever delight Rudra, lord of elephants.*[12]

Madhavi. Friend, enough of doubts: take it that the lady has already come.

(Enter Madanika.)

Madanika. Child, fortune smiles on you!

Radha *(with a joyful sigh, Prakrit)*. Lady, what news from there?

Madanika. Such as there is in a violent fever of love.

Radha *(Prakrit)*. How so?

Madanika.

> ***43.*** *He reviles the moon, scatters the sandal, throws off His long necklace, shrinks from the dew, and now does not even speak to His dear companions. What does Govinda, afflicted by separation from you, not do? So, Radha, gladden Him — He thinks only of preparing a bed deep in the bower.*[13]

(Then, in the bower, Krishna.)

Krishna. Friend, why does Madanika delay so? *(Anxiously.)*

> ***44.*** *This slender one walks slowly, weighed down by her full breasts and hips; and this bower I have appointed for our tryst is far away. The girl is timid by nature, and the forest lies in dreadful blinding darkness; how is she to come to Me? Here love alone is the refuge.*[14]

(Acting a moment's reflection, sighing long and hot.)

> ***45.*** *Has she taken Me for a stranger to her feeling and turned away? Did she not trust her friend's words? Or has she lost her way in this forest so full of darkness — or, struck by Smara's arrows, is the tender one unable to walk?*

(Looking ahead.) Ah, it seems the moon is about to rise! For:

> ***46.*** *As the plaintive cries of the cakravakas spread, as the night-lilies all around open wider and wider, as at every step the lotus beds close — so, I fear, the moon is already strolling on the paths of the eastern mountain.*[15]

(Sadly.)

> ***47.*** *Somehow trusting her friend's words, she may already, in a dress suited to the darkness, have come half-way along the path — and now this wretched moon has defiled the eastern quarter. Bewildered, she can neither come on nor go back today — what will the clever one do?*[16]

(Folding His hands respectfully.)

> ***48.*** *O eastern mountain, my friend! Be kind and stretch your hundreds of peaks up high: if the moon comes into view, it will be an obstacle to the doe-eyed one's journey and to My very life.*

Jester *(listening, Prakrit)*. Hey, listen — what's that going "runu-runu"?

Krishna *(listening towards the wings)*.

> ***50.*** *"Is it the sound of her anklets? Or the humming of a swarm of bees? Or the tinkling of her girdle? Or the cry of sarasa cranes in love?" — while Govinda was thus wondering, Radhika, leaning on her friend's hand, soon became the ornament of His bower-house of play.*[17]

Song 17 — in raga Malava-shri.

> ***51.*** *The flowers in her wave-like tresses are like foam; with a movement of her right eye she seems to bid the Bodiless One dance.*
> *For play with Madhava, Radha goes to Hari with slow steps, her necklace gently swaying. (Refrain.)*
> *With the corner of her sweet glance, trembling with apprehension, shyness and the fullness of rasa, she lovingly offers the Slayer of Madhu a garland of blue lilies.*[18]
> *May this, spoken by the poet Ramananda Raya, sweetly delight with floods of rasa Gajapati Rudra, lord of men, the new Madana of our time.*

Jester *(looking ahead, Prakrit)*. Hey friend, we've won! It looks as though the lady is coming over there.

(Enter Madanika.)

Madanika. Children, at long last the wish of your friends is fulfilled. So give me leave to go elsewhere.

Jester *(Prakrit)*. And me — to another bower!

(Exeunt omnes.)

End of the Fourth Act, "Radha-abhisara".

1. Madanika sees Krishna suffering in separation. His face has faded like a lotus under the moon (the lotus closes at night), and His dark chest is compared to an emerald rock. The first word of the song is printed "madana" ("Kama"); by the sense and the Hindi translation we read "vadana" ("face"). The last line is unclear.

2. *Śārdūla-vikrīḍita* metre. Krishna repents of His feigned refusal (Act 2). "Thrown away a jewel, thinking it a shell" is a proverbial image. There is no stage direction here in the Sanskrit text.

3. The jester jokes that as a brahmin he will "draw" Radha by an attraction-spell (*ākarṣaṇa*).

4. The jester shows Madanika dry leaves: everything fresh in the forest has already been gathered for cooling beds for the suffering Krishna. The direction "using Sanskrit" refers to the following song (sung by the jester or Madanika; the edition does not name the character).

5. Rahu is the demon who swallows the moon at an eclipse. In separation Krishna cannot bear the moonlight and calls for Rahu to "swallow" the moon. The first line of the song is corrupt in the print and is rendered by the sense and the edition's Hindi translation.

6. *Śikhariṇī* metre. The beginning of the verse is corrupt in the print. Krishna loved the Malaya breeze because it touches Radha, but now, in separation, the breeze torments Him too.

7. Signs of the "fever of love" (*madana-jvara*): Radha seeks cooling with sandal, "cool moon" (camphor) and lotus leaves, but the heat of her body is such that the leaves wither and rustle.

8. "Torment" — printed *vāmam*, "perversely, hostilely" (Hindi: "being crooked"). Krishna dwells in Radha's heart and yet does not quench her longing — a sign of the highest love in separation (*vipralambha*).

9. The jester compares Radha's and Krishna's sufferings. The owl cannot bear the sun and the snake flees from the charmer's spell; to Krishna in separation the moon and sandal are unbearable.

10. *Śikhariṇī* metre. Madanika relates that Radha was tested with intimidation and reminders of duty (cf. Act 3, Shashimukhi), but her love did not waver — a sign of *anurāga*, unwavering love that knows no obstacles.

11. *Vasanta-tilakā* metre (printed as prose in the edition). "Causeless" (*akāraṇa-vatsalā*) — the friend's selfless love for both lovers, as Rupa Gosvami describes the sakhis, who are happy only in the union of Radha and Krishna.

12. Radha has come to the place of the tryst (*abhisāra*) at night through the dark forest — in poetics an *abhisārikā*, a heroine going to her lover. In the Gaudiya Vaishnava tradition her journey through darkness and danger is an image of all-conquering prema, which takes no account of any obstacle.

13. *Śārdūla-vikrīḍita* metre. The print has *prāleyāṁtra sati*, read as *prāleyāt trasati*, "shrinks from the dew".

14. *Śikhariṇī* metre. "Here love alone is the refuge" (*kāmo 'tra śaraṇam*): *kāma* here is the same prema (CC Adi 4.163).

15. At night the cakravakas are parted and cry, night-lilies open and day-lotuses close — all signs of moonrise. The eastern mountain (Udayagiri) is the mountain behind which, by tradition, the sun and moon rise.

16. The moonlight will betray Radha, dressed in dark clothes for a night tryst (*tamisrābhisārikā*). "Eastern quarter" — literally "the quarter of Shakra", that is, of Indra.

17. *Śārdūla-vikrīḍita* metre. A charming scene of uncertainty (*sandeha*): Krishna at first mistakes the sound of Radha's anklets for other sounds.

18. Madhu-mathana — "Slayer of Madhu", Krishna. The garland is a sign of choosing the beloved. In the last line King Prataparudra is called "the new Madana of our time" — courtly praise of his beauty. The words "bid the Bodiless One dance" are unclear in the print (*nartitumatanumanāmaṁ*).

Act Five. Radha-sangama (Union with Radha)

Dawn after the night in the grove; Madanika tells Shashimukhi of the meeting of Radha and Madhava; Radha, abashed, returns in the light of morning; an alarm behind the scenes — the bull-demon Arishtasura has burst into Vraja; Krishna slays him; Madanika again unites Radha with Krishna; the closing benediction.

(Enter Shashimukhi.)

Shashimukhi *(Prakrit)*. Ah, I don't know what happened today in the grove with those two intent on bliss. I'll follow the lady and find out. *(Looking ahead.)* Ah, here she comes, slowly, slowly, her eyes closed with sleep. *(Using Sanskrit.)*

> ***2.*** *Slowly, slowly, somehow lifting her eyes with their almost motionless pupils, her shoulders drooping and her arms hanging loose, stepping so languidly that her feet falter and the jingling of her anklets falters too — the lady, her body wholly overcome by sleep, shows her joy.*[1]

Song 18 — in raga Sukha-sindhura.

> ***3.*** *Her eyes half-closed and reddish, her face here seeming to have lost its glow — like a red lotus at dawn reflected in the water beside the moon.*
> *What is this? As she enters, my mind sees in her a woman leaving after love-play. (Refrain.)*
> *Her arms are slack, and again and again her golden, jewelled bangles softly tinkle; setting her feet unevenly, she stills the jingling of her anklets, their lovely play.*
> *May these words of the poet Ramananda Raya bring joy to the heart of Gajapati Rudra, lord of men, and sport among the connoisseurs.*[2]

(Enter Madanika, dressed as described. Rubbing her eyes, looking ahead.)

Madanika. Ah, how lovely is the close of a spring night! For:

> ***5.*** *Here gently, gently blows a breeze from the lotus beds; there is the chatter of cuckoos delighted by the taste of mango; somewhere, the humming of bees about a blossoming creeper; somewhere, the soft, sweet, joyful murmur of the cakravakas.*[3]

(Walking a few steps, showing joy.)

> ***6.*** *The young couples who, through mutual love and acquaintance with the skill of ardent Smara, stayed awake all this night, are now asleep in their houses; and as if to vie with their breathing, the wind from the sandal paths plays over the rows of opening lotuses.*

(Looking ahead, in wonder.)

> ***7.*** *Here startled, startled, there unceasingly joyful, here lowering and there raising her eyes — so behaves this female cakravaka, that even clever young wives might become her pupils.*[4]

(Going aside a moment, in amazement.) Ah, here is something lovelier still! For:

> ***8.*** *Seeing her own reflection in an opening lotus full of honey and taking it for her mate, the female bee eagerly darts to it; then, seeing her true companion arriving, abashed, the clever one can neither stay nor go, and long keeps circling.*[5]

Shashimukhi. She is so captivated by the loveliness of the morning that she does not see me. *(Approaching with the words "I bow to you.")* Lady, I bow to you.

Madanika. What, Shashimukhi, child! Lost in thought, I did not notice you for a long while.

Shashimukhi. Lady, why do you seem to me as if overcome by sleep?

Madanika. Child, why "as if"? I am.

Shashimukhi. But why?

Madanika.

> ***14.*** *Today Radha and Madhava were in the grove; watching their wondrous play, I passed this night without sleep.*

Shashimukhi. And what happened there?

Madanika. Listen. *(Wiping her eyes.)* Child, you know what happened until they entered the grove.

Shashimukhi. Of course.

Madanika. After that —

> ***18.*** *the stupor that seized the Enemy of Mura made even her mind, full of love and shyness, fear that He was indifferent; and had not His trembling, stirred by the wind of the feathers of Kama's arrows, reassured her, the doe-eyed one would not have been comforted.*[6]

Shashimukhi. Joy, joy! I am fulfilled.

Madanika. And from here on the friends are fulfilled still more.

Shashimukhi. Did the lady see anything else?

Madanika. Everything.

Shashimukhi. And then?

Madanika. Child,

> ***24.*** *with apprehension and with love, with laughter, with shyness, with pride, with jealous pique, with captivating words, with tenderness, with longing — such was then in the grove the love-play of Radha and Madhusudana that Madana himself was filled with wonder.*[7]

Song 19 — in raga Ahira.

> ***25.*** *To the soft jingling of her anklets she came near the couch; and the Enemy of Madhu too took a few steps towards her, in keeping with her.*
> *Shashimukhi, what shall I tell you? I have seen a wonder — the fullness of the play of Radha and Madhava! (Refrain.)*
> *And so, it is said, their two bodies were united so that no difference remained; friend, as if pierced by the arrows of the Odd-arrowed One, they forgot their long sorrow.*
> *And though wounded by nails and teeth, they sighed deeply as if in fear. May this fine song of Ramananda Raya increase the joy of Rudra, lord of elephants.*[8]

Shashimukhi. Lady, this seems to me almost incongruous.

Madanika. How so?

Shashimukhi. Where did they get such skill in love?

Madanika. Ah, simple girl!

> ***29.*** *A teacher instructs with great effort, and the teaching ripens in time — so it is with all the sciences; but the arts of love arise of themselves.*[9]
>
> ***30.*** *Meanwhile the moon, having long, it seems, been schooled in those arts of love-play, now, as if to put its training into practice, devotedly clung to the western quarter.*[10]

Shashimukhi. And now my heart longs to see the most lovely bodies of those two blessed ones, adorned with the marks of nails and teeth, content with the long-awaited bliss of their desired meeting.

(Enter Radhika in haste; Krishna at some distance.)

Radha *(looking ahead, Prakrit)*. Ah, the quarters are growing light! How shall I go without covering my body? *(Hurrying two or three steps, she looks back, turning her neck.)*

Krishna *(gazing a moment)*. Ah, how fear and love are mingled in the doe-eyed one!

> ***33.*** *Two or three steps she goes quickly, two or three again slowly; trembling with fear, she gazes meaningfully about the quarters; and my beloved, though I am near, at every step thinks me far away, as though I were not even within sight of her eyes.*[11]

Radha *(hurries on again)*.

Madanika. Child, look, look: ahead is Radhika, and a little way off, Madhava. For she

> ***35.*** *fears a snake in front of her less than a stump far off; is less alarmed by an elephant's roar than by the cawing of a flock of crows; is less bewildered in darkness than in bright light; and so, I think, she is less distressed in separation than in union with her beloved.*[12]

Song 20 — in raga Lalita.

> ***36.*** *In the special battle of the Lord of Rati, befitting the deep cherished desire, where the heart is stolen by knowing both victory and defeat and longing grows —*
> *she, with her graceful, captivating body, by the gentle movement of her lotus feet, most skilful, tells what has passed. (Refrain.)*
> *Where the enchanting sounds are like the twang of the many arrows of the flower-bow; where the marks of nails and teeth are devised as a sequence of merits —*
> *make your hearts free of fault as you hear this, spoken by the poet Ramananda Raya, known to Gajapati Rudra, lord of men, and giving joy to the connoisseurs.*[13]

Madanika. The girl is timid with great fear. Let us go and reassure her. *(Approaching.)* Child, welcome.

Radha *(looking in confusion, Prakrit)*. Ah, it is the lady! *(Bows bashfully.)*

An uproar behind the scenes: "Disaster! Disaster!" *(All listen.)*

Again behind the scenes:

> ***40.*** *Gouging the earth with his horns and hooves, splitting the quarters with a roar like the thunder of clouds at the end of the world, rolling in fury his eyes that blaze like meteors, challenging to combat — by fate Arishta has appeared before us, plunging Vraja into calamity.*

(All hide in the depths of the grove and watch.)

Krishna *(advancing boldly)*. Fear not, dwellers of the cowherd village! *(Raising His arm proudly.)*

> ***42.*** *While this arm of Krishna is awake — the great prop of the earth with its ring of mountains crumbled by arrogant danavas, the towering sacrificial post at the rite of appeasement for Shakra harassed by enemies — fear will never touch even the cowherds whose sole refuge it is. Ah, this bull is toying with My life! (He strides forth boldly.)*[14]

Behind the scenes:

> ***43.*** *Alas, alas! Those horns with which he split the mountains, unable to bear their pride in their peaks, he has now aimed at Mukunda, the boy whose body is tender as a blue lotus!*

Madanika *(watching, in tears)*.

44. *Today, Earth, bear an immeasurable burden; gods, whence your hope of victory? Goddess Shri, take up the vow; people of Vraja, where now is even the news of joy for you? Mother Devaki, what will become of you? Nanda and the rest, you are lost; Radhika, the world has become empty for you today. Alas, alas, we are undone!*[15]

Radha *(listening, in fear, Prakrit)*. Woe is me, unfortunate! So this is how evil fate has played!

Shashimukhi. Friend, take heart, take heart — this is Mukunda!

Behind the scenes:

47. *He at whose opening of the eyes the three worlds closed theirs, at whose rising they bowed down, before whose whirling in the sky even the winds hardly dared to whirl — that Arishta Sriman Mukunda, as if playing with a ball, has hurled far from Vrindavana and slain, and has made the world free of calamity.*[16]

(Enter Krishna.)

All *(gaze at Him eagerly)*.

Madanika. Ah, how lovely is the child adorned with victory! For:

49. *His creeper-like locks dishevelled and matted with drops of sweat, the sandal on His forehead washed away, the peacock feather of His crest gradually slipping, the lovely colour of His body set off by the dust raised by His steps — so appearing, Madhava, after long waiting, delights the eyes.*

(Approaching.) What good fortune, child, that we see you chosen by Victory herself![17]

Krishna *(seeing her, joyfully)*. Lady, welcome.

Madanika. Now that we see the child adorned with victory, all is truly well. So rest a while here, child, on the path by the vakula tree.

Krishna. As the lady wishes. *(Sits down.)*

Madanika *(touching Him affectionately)*. Child, you have done a hard deed — I wish to give you a reward.

Krishna. As the lady wishes.

Madanika *(goes out and returns with Radha)*. Child,

56. *she has not yet recovered from the new meeting; her eyes are wide with fear; honour her with Your sweet glance, as if after a long separation.*

Krishna *(gazes eagerly)*.

Madanika. Daughter,

58. *fan your beloved, beaded with drops of sweat from the fierce fight, with the hem of your garment, and gladden him with a loving word.*

Radha *(fans Him lovingly)*.

Madanika. What more can I do to please You?

Krishna. Lady, is there anything more pleasing than this?

61. *When the arrows of the Five-arrowed One were piercing Me on every side, the doe-eyed one, sole source of My bliss, was won for Me by your grace; and again I have gained a stream of nectar for My eyes. What, lady, can there be in the world more pleasing still for such as Me?*

Song 21 — in raga Mangala-gurjari.

> ***62.*** *The moon-faced one, like the full autumn moon, filled with great love, has joined Me, and her hand is in Mine.*
> *Lady, what else here could be desired by Me? The fruit of many good deeds has come of itself. (Refrain.)*
> *The cuckoos, the moon, spring and the swarms of bees — all now fill Me with happiness.*
> *May this, spoken by Ramananda — the play of Hari — bring King Rudra happiness and immortality.*[18]

And still, let this be so:

> ***63.*** *Whoever, his mind bound by faith, eagerly serves day by day this incomparable secret, the nectar of the play of Me, Gopala — on him, whose mind is given to Me, may you always look with a gracious eye, so that he may attain the perfection he desires in the forests of Vraja.*[19]

Madanika. So be it.

(Exeunt omnes.)

End of the Fifth Act, "Radha-sangama".

Thus ends the drama "Sri Jagannatha-vallabha", composed by Ramananda Raya.

1. *Mandākrāntā* metre. Shashimukhi sees Madanika (the Forest-goddess), who has not slept all night. "Her feet falter" — the print reads *maṁdayāsa*, corrected in the edition's errata to *mandanyāsa* ("slow step").

2. Madanika, sleepless all night, resembles a woman after love-play. This is a hint, explained later: she spent the whole night watching the play of Radha and Krishna (verse 14). The first line of the song is unclear in places. For Gaudiya Vaishnavas the joy of the sakhis lies in arranging and beholding the meeting of Radha and Krishna, not in enjoying Krishna themselves (cf. CC Madhya 8.206–208).

3. *Śikhariṇī* metre. A description of dawn (*prabhāta*), obligatory in Sanskrit drama. The end of the third line is unclear in the print.

4. The last line is unclear. The edition's Hindi translation reads: "what clever woman does not imitate this cakravaka?" In the morning the female cakravaka is reunited with her mate after the night's separation.

5. An allegory: the female bee who took a reflection for her beloved and then sees the real one is an image of the mingling of conflicting emotions (*bhāva-śābalya*).

6. *Śārdūla-vikrīḍita* metre. Stupor (*stambha*) and trembling (*kampa*) are *sāttvika-bhāvas*, bodily signs of ecstatic love: Radha at first took Krishna's stupor for indifference and only by His trembling understood His love. The beginning of the third line is unclear in the print.

7. Here and further on (verses 24–36) Ramananda describes the highest stage of madhura-rasa, *sambhoga*, the union of Radha and Krishna, in the language of classical poetics. Srila Bhaktisiddhanta Sarasvati stresses that these pastimes (*aprākṛta-līlā*) have nothing in common with worldly relationships. Their participants are Bhagavan Himself and His own pleasure-potency (*hlādinī-śakti*). Such descriptions are meant only for devotees whose hearts are purified, and they must not be understood in a worldly way or imitated (cf. CC Adi 4.164–171: kama and prema differ as iron and gold). Ramananda himself calls them a "secret" in his closing verse 63, meant for those who serve Gopala's pastimes with faith.

8. The print has *niśvasitāyatabhītaṁ*, whose sense is unclear. The edition's Hindi translation reads "began to breathe heavily in fear": the agitation came not from pain but from the fullness of love. Cf. note 7.

9. *Puṣpitāgrā* metre. Shashimukhi is surprised, since Radha and Krishna are still young. Madanika replies that love needs no teaching. For Gaudiya Vaishnavas this reflects the eternal, self-manifest nature of their love: it is not acquired but abides eternally in Radha and Krishna.

10. *Vasanta-tilakā* metre. The moon "clung to the western quarter", that is, it set and dawn came — a play on the image of the moon as a lover.

11. *Śārdūla-vikrīḍita* metre. Returning in the morning, Radha fears being seen. Lines 3–4 are partly unclear in the print and are rendered by the sense and the edition's Hindi translation.

12. *Śārdūla-vikrīḍita* metre. Radha fears the harmless (a stump, a crow, light) more than real danger; likewise, meeting her beloved, she is more anxious than in separation, from fear of being seen and from the fullness of feeling.

13. The song continues the description of *sambhoga* (see note 7). The sense of "by the gentle movement of her lotus feet" (printed *mṛdupadakamalalavehā*) is unclear. The edition's Hindi translation reads: "it is at once understood from the gentle movement of her lotus feet". The closing line in the original is an appeal to the audience: "make your hearts free of fault". The connoisseurs are to hear this with a pure heart.

14. The slaying of Arishtasura is told in *Bhāgavata Purāṇa* 10.36. "Prop of the earth" alludes to the lifting of Govardhana Hill. "Sacrificial post of the appeasement of Shakra" means Krishna's arm as the support that averts Indra's wrath. Ramananda joins this pastime to the dawn after the night in the grove. In the *Bhāgavata* Arishta comes in the evening, but as a dramatist Ramananda is free in ordering the events.

15. *Śārdūla-vikrīḍita* metre. Madanika despairs, thinking Krishna in danger. "Mother Devaki": according to the edition's gloss, this is Yashoda's second name ("Nanda's wife has two names, Yashoda and Devaki"), as she is also called in some Puranas. "Shri, take up the vow" means "take the vow of widowhood".

16. *Śārdūla-vikrīḍita* metre. Krishna hurled Arishta "like a ball": in the *Bhāgavata* (10.36) Krishna, seizing the bull by the horns, threw it down and killed it.

17. "Chosen by Victory herself" — literally "embraced by the goddess of Victory at her *svayaṁvara*", the ceremony at which a bride chooses her husband.

18. The last song of the drama, sung by Krishna. The twenty-one songs of the drama are passages 1.4, 1.22, 1.28, 1.37, 2.20, 2.24, 2.35, 2.46, 3.3, 3.8, 3.15, 3.34, 4.2, 4.15, 4.25, 4.37, 4.51, 5.3, 5.25, 5.36 and 5.62 of the edition. They are written in the style of Jayadeva's *Gīta-govinda*, each with a raga, a refrain (*dhruva*) and a closing line naming the author and dedicated to Prataparudra.

19. *Śārdūla-vikrīḍita* metre. The closing benediction (*bharata-vākya*). Krishna asks the Forest-goddess (Madanika) to look graciously on those who with faith "serve" this "secret, the nectar of Gopala's play" (hearing, singing or staging it), so that they may attain perfection in Vraja. For Gaudiya Vaishnavas this points to the path of *rāgānugā-bhakti* under the guidance of Radha's companions. According to the CC, Mahaprabhu sang and heard the "songs of Raya's drama" day and night with Svarupa Damodara and Ramananda Raya (Madhya 2.77) and relished its verses in His ecstatic moods (Antya 20.67).